

AI Literacy Curriculum for Kindergarten (Age 5)

Inspired by Maryland's AI Ready Schools Act (SB 720, effective June 1, 2026)

A structured, fun, and engaging 36-week program designed for a 5-year-old boy — with a weekly "Vibe Coding Friday" elective.

Background

Maryland became one of the first states to require AI literacy across K-12 education. The Artificial Intelligence Ready Schools Act (SB 720), sponsored by Senators Brooks, Hester, Harris, Attar, Feldman, and Watson, went into effect on June 1, 2026, requiring every Maryland school system to incorporate AI literacy into workforce preparation and computer science standards from kindergarten through grade 12 by June 2027.

As Senator Hester noted, every student will graduate into a world where nearly every career uses AI in some way, and it's our responsibility to make sure they're prepared.

This curriculum translates that mandate into a parent-friendly, play-based program for a 5-year-old.

Source: AfroTech — [This State Just Passed A Bill Requiring AI Literacy For K-12 Students](#)

Core Principles (What a 5-Year-Old CAN Learn)

✔ Teach This	✗ NOT This (Save for Age 8+)
AI is made by people	Neural networks
AI follows patterns and rules	Algorithms (abstract)
AI can be a helpful tool	Data privacy concepts
AI makes mistakes	Coding syntax
Humans are unique — we feel, create, care	Machine learning math

Session Rules:

- Keep every activity to **15–20 minutes** max
- Always frame AI as **a tool, not magic**: "The computer learned from examples people showed it"
- **Celebrate errors**: When AI gets something wrong, that's the best learning moment
- **Make it physical**: The best AI lessons at this age use bodies, objects, and movement
- No testing or grading — **exposure and wonder** are the goals

Weekly Schedule Overview

Day	Focus	Duration
Monday	AI Concept of the Week (unplugged activity)	15-20 min
Tuesday	Storytime + Discussion (AI-themed book or story)	15 min
Wednesday	Hands-On AI Tool Exploration (screen time)	15-20 min
Thursday	Creative Project / Craft (reinforce the week's concept)	20 min
Friday	 Vibe Coding Elective (see Section below)	20-30 min

Semester 1: "What Is AI?" (Weeks 1-18)

Unit 1: AI Is All Around Us (Weeks 1-4)

Week 1 — "Smart Helpers at Home"

- **Mon (Unplugged):** Walk around the house — point out devices that "seem smart" (Alexa, phone autocomplete, YouTube suggestions). Ask: "Is this alive? Does it think?"
- **Tue (Story):** Tell a story about a robot that can sort toys by color but doesn't know what "favorite" means
- **Wed (Tool):** Google Quick, Draw! — draw things and watch AI try to guess. Ask: "Did it know what it was? Or just match a pattern?"
- **Thu (Craft):** Draw "My Robot Friend" — what can it do? What can't it do?
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — Introduction: open the app, meet the cat, tap the green flag

Week 2 — "People Make AI"

- **Mon:** Role play — one person is the "robot," the other gives instructions to make a sandwich. The robot only does EXACTLY what you say (literal instructions = how computers work)
- **Tue:** Read *Hello Ruby* by Linda Liukas (or watch the read-aloud on YouTube)
- **Wed:** Google AutoDraw — doodle a cat, watch AI suggest clean versions. "YOU decided what to draw. AI is the helper, not the boss."
- **Thu:** Make a "How I Taught My Robot" comic strip (3 panels)
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make the cat walk across the screen

Week 3 — "AI Follows Rules"

- **Mon:** Pattern game with colored blocks: Red-Blue-Red-Blue-___? "You just did what AI does! AI finds patterns and predicts what comes next."
- **Tue:** Story about a pattern-finding robot that gets tricked by a new color
- **Wed:** Quick, Draw! again — this time, draw something silly on purpose and watch AI get confused
- **Thu:** Make a "Pattern Necklace" with beads — create a pattern, then predict the next bead
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — add a second character and make them talk

Week 4 — "AI Makes Mistakes"

- **Mon:** Play "Guess What I'm Thinking" — give clues about an animal. Sometimes the guess is wrong! "Even AI gets wrong answers."
- **Tue:** Story about a spell-checker that changes words to funny wrong words
- **Wed:** Use AutoDraw — draw something abstract and see how hilariously wrong the suggestions can be. Celebrate the mistakes!
- **Thu:** "Oops! AI Art" — intentionally make bad drawings and laugh at AI's guesses. Collage the funniest results
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — record your own voice for a character

Unit 2: How Does AI Learn? (Weeks 5-9)

Week 5 — "Sorting Like AI"

- **Mon:** Sorting game — sort toy animals into groups (by color, size, legs). Then ask: "What if we sort by something different? Is a tomato a fruit or a vegetable?"
- **Tue:** Story about a robot that sorts mail but puts birthday cards in the "boring letters" pile
- **Wed:** Google Teachable Machine (parent-guided) — train the computer to recognize hand gestures
- **Thu:** Make a "Sorting Machine" out of cardboard boxes — label categories, sort household items
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make a simple animation (character + background)

Week 6 — "Learning From Examples"

- **Mon:** Show 10 photos of cats and 10 photos of dogs. "If I showed the computer thousands of these, it could learn to tell them apart — just like you!"
- **Tue:** Story about training a pet vs. training a computer
- **Wed:** Quick, Draw! — notice how AI gets better at recognizing common objects vs. rare ones
- **Thu:** "Train Your Friend" game — show a friend 5 pictures of your favorite animal, then test them with a tricky one

- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make a character react when you tap it

Week 7 — "Patterns in Music"

- **Mon:** Clap a rhythm pattern. Can you predict what comes next? "AI listens for patterns in music too!"
- **Tue:** Listen to a song, then a computer-generated melody. "Which one makes you feel something?"
- **Wed:** Chrome Music Lab — explore Song Maker and Rhythm
- **Thu:** Make a "Pattern Song" with pots, pans, and spoons
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — add sounds to your animation

Week 8 — "AI Sees Pictures"

- **Mon:** Play "I Spy" but describe things the way a computer would: "I see something round and red" (not "I see something yummy")
- **Tue:** Story about a robot that thinks a fire hydrant is a short red person
- **Wed:** Google Lens (on parent's phone) — point it at objects and see what AI thinks they are
- **Thu:** Draw an object from 3 angles. "AI needs lots of views to understand things too!"
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — build a 2-page story

Week 9 — "AI and Words"

- **Mon:** Play "Finish My Sentence" — start a sentence, let your child complete it. "That's what phones do when they suggest the next word!"
- **Tue:** Silly story where autocorrect changes every word wrong
- **Wed:** Parent types something into phone keyboard — show predictive text suggestions. "The phone guesses from patterns of what people type."
- **Thu:** Write a 3-sentence story together, then change one word to something silly. "AI doesn't always pick the right word either!"
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — free build day (make anything you want!)

Unit 3: AI and Me (Weeks 10-14)

Week 10 — "AI Is a Tool, Like a Hammer"

- **Mon:** Line up tools: hammer, paintbrush, calculator, tablet. "Which ones are alive? Which ones think? None! They're all tools that help people."
- **Tue:** Story about a boy who uses different tools for different jobs
- **Wed:** AutoDraw — create a "My Toolbox" poster using AI-assisted drawings
- **Thu:** Build something with LEGO. "YOU are the designer. The blocks are the tool."
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make a character navigate a maze

Week 11 — "Things Only Humans Can Do"

- **Mon:** Discuss: Can AI give a hug? Can AI be your best friend? Can AI imagine a brand new animal?
- **Tue:** Story about things robots wish they could do (feel rain, taste ice cream, dream)
- **Wed:** Use Quick, Draw! — after the game, try drawing something that has never existed. "AI can only copy patterns from things people already made. YOU can imagine new things."
- **Thu:** Invent and draw a brand-new animal. Name it. Where does it live?
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — animate your invented animal

Week 12 — "Staying Safe"

- **Mon:** Practice: "What's your name?" "I don't share that with computers." Role-play safe vs. unsafe sharing
- **Tue:** Story about a friendly robot that asks too many questions
- **Wed:** Parent-guided: explore a kid-safe voice assistant. Practice saying "I need to ask a grown-up"
- **Thu:** Make a "Safe Online" poster with rules
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — add a "safety message" to a story project

Week 13 — "Asking Good Questions"

- **Mon:** "20 Questions" game — practice asking yes/no questions to narrow things down. "This is how search engines find answers!"
- **Tue:** Story about a kid who asks the right questions to solve a mystery
- **Wed:** Parent types a question into a search engine together. See how different questions give different results
- **Thu:** Draw 3 questions you'd like to ask a robot
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — build a quiz game (character asks a question, you pick an answer)

Week 14 — Semester 1 Showcase

- **Mon-Thu:** Review favorite activities. Pick your best ScratchJr project and best craft
- **Fri:** 🎤 **Show & Tell** — present your favorite project to family. Explain one thing about AI

Semester 2: "AI and the World" (Weeks 19–36)

Unit 4: AI Helpers in the Real World (Weeks 19–23)

Week 19 — "AI in the Doctor's Office"

- **Mon:** Discuss: How does a doctor know you're sick? What if a computer could help by looking at X-rays?
- **Wed:** Look at simple X-ray images online together — play "find the broken bone"
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make a "Doctor Robot" character that asks how you feel

Week 20 — "AI and Animals"

- **Mon:** Discuss: Scientists use cameras and AI to count animals in the wild so they can protect them
- **Wed:** Watch a short wildlife camera clip — try to count animals yourself. "Now imagine a computer doing that ALL day!"
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — build an animal-counting game

Week 21 — "AI and Weather"

- **Mon:** Look at a 5-day weather forecast. "The computer looks at patterns from MILLIONS of past weather days to guess tomorrow."
- **Wed:** Make your own "weather predictor" — look outside, check the sky, make a prediction. Compare with the app!
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make a weather scene that changes

Week 22 — "AI and Cars"

- **Mon:** Discuss self-driving cars. Use toy cars — "What rules would you give a robot car?"
- **Wed:** Build a road from tape on the floor. Be the "robot car" — someone else gives directions. What happens when instructions are bad?
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — program a car to drive along a path

Week 23 — "AI and Art"

- **Mon:** Compare a hand-drawn picture to an AutoDraw version. "Which one has more feeling?"
- **Wed:** Create a side-by-side: your drawing vs. AI's version of the same thing
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make an interactive art gallery

Unit 5: Being a Good AI Citizen (Weeks 24-28)

Week 24 — "Fair or Unfair?"

- **Mon:** Sort a pile of mixed items using ONLY one rule (e.g., only by color). "Did we miss something important? When AI sorts by only one thing, it can be unfair too."
- **Wed:** Play a simplified "fair sharing" game
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make a "sharing" story

Week 25 — "AI Doesn't Feel"

- **Mon:** Role-play emotions — happy, sad, angry, excited. "Can a computer really feel these? Or just pretend?"
- **Wed:** If available, talk to a voice assistant and ask "Are you happy?" Discuss the answer
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — make characters show emotions through movement

Week 26 — "When to Use AI, When to Use Your Brain"

- **Mon:** Scenarios: "Should you use AI to...do your homework? help you spell a word? pick your best friend? find a recipe?"
- **Wed:** "Human or Computer?" sorting cards — which jobs need a human touch?
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — free build (most creative project yet!)

Weeks 27-28 — "My AI Inventions"

- Kids design their dream helpful robot over two weeks: what does it do, what can't it do, how would you teach it?
- Build a cardboard robot prototype
- **Fri (Vibe Coding):** ScratchJr — animate your dream robot

Unit 6: Final Projects (Weeks 29-36)

- **Weeks 29-34:** Guided project work — kids choose one of:
 1. An "AI Storybook" (illustrated, with AI concepts woven in)
 2. A ScratchJr multi-screen interactive story
 3. A physical "Robot Museum" from crafts made all year
- **Week 35:** Rehearse presentations
- **Week 36:** 🏠 **End-of-Year AI Showcase** — present to family and friends

🎮 Vibe Coding Friday — Weekly Elective

What Is Vibe Coding?

Vibe coding is describing what you want to build in plain language (or through visual blocks) and letting the tool bring it to life. For a 5-year-old, this means **ScratchJr** — dragging colorful blocks to make characters move, talk, and interact.

Tools (All Free)

Tool	What It Does	Link
ScratchJr (primary)	Drag-and-drop coding for ages 5-7. Make stories, games, animations	scratchjr.org
Code Karts	Pre-reader coding through racing puzzles	App Store / Google Play
Google Quick, Draw!	Draw + watch AI guess (used in AI lessons too)	quickdraw.withgoogle.com
Google AutoDraw	Doodle → AI-polished art	autodraw.com
Chrome Music Lab	Music + pattern exploration	musiclab.chromeexperiments.com

Vibe Coding Scope & Sequence (36 Weeks)

Weeks	Phase	Skills	Projects
1-4	Explore	Open app, tap blocks, move characters	Make the cat walk, jump, spin
5-9	Create	Sequence blocks, add characters, add sounds	Simple 2-character animation
10-14	Story	Multi-page projects, voice recording, backgrounds	Interactive 3-page story
15-18	Game Basics	Tap reactions, simple cause-and-effect	"Tap the character" game
19-23	Remix	Copy and modify existing projects	Remix a friend's or template project
24-28	Design	Plan before building, sketch on paper first	"My Dream Game" blueprint → build
29-34	Capstone	Combine all skills into one project	Multi-page story OR game
35-36	Showcase	Present and explain what you built	Demo day!

Parent's Role During Vibe Coding

- Sit together — this is not solo screen time

- Let HIM drive the iPad/tablet
 - Ask: "What do you want to happen next?" (not "here, let me do it")
 - When something breaks: "That's great! What should we try differently?"
 - Keep sessions to **20-30 minutes max**
-

Free Resources & Links

Curriculum & Lesson Plans

- [Day of AI — Free K-12 Curriculum \(MIT\)](#) — includes early elementary units with stories, movement, and play
- [SchoolAI — AI Literacy for Students](#) — zero-tech activity ideas for K-2
- [Robo Wunderkind — K-5 AI Literacy Curriculum](#) — structured AI + robotics program
- [KidsAiTools — AI for Kindergarten Students](#) — 10 tools and activities for 5-6 year olds

Tools for the Child

- [ScratchJr](#) — primary coding tool (iPad, Android, Chromebook)
- [Google Quick, Draw!](#) — AI guessing game (browser)
- [Google AutoDraw](#) — AI drawing assistant (browser)
- [Chrome Music Lab](#) — music + patterns (browser)
- [Code.org — Pre-Reader Express](#) — visual coding puzzles

For Parents

- [KidsAiTools — AI Literacy for Kids \(Parent Guide\)](#) — how to teach AI concepts at home in 10-minute sessions
- [The 74 — Why AI Literacy Should Start Before Kindergarten](#) — research-backed case for early AI education
- [Common Sense Education — AI Literacy Lessons](#) — for when he's older

Vibe Coding (For When He's Ready to Level Up, Age 8+)

- [Scratch](#) — full version of Scratch for ages 8-12
 - [DIY.org Vibe Coder](#) — kid-safe AI coding tool
 - [CodaKid Vibe Coding Guide](#) — overview of vibe coding for kids
 - [imagic x Lovable — Hour of AI Vibe Coding](#) — classroom vibe coding with privacy safeguards
-

Quick-Reference: Conversation Starters

Use these during everyday moments — no lesson plan needed:

Moment	What to Say
YouTube suggests a video	"How do you think it knew you'd like that?"
Phone autocompletes a word	"The phone is guessing! Is it right?"
Voice assistant answers	"Is Alexa alive? Does she feel happy?"
A photo app recognizes faces	"How did it know that's Grandma?"
A recommendation is wrong	"See? Even computers get things wrong!"
Playing with toys	"If a robot sorted your toys, what rule would you give it?"

Assessment (Observation-Based, Not Tests)

By year's end, look for these behaviors:

- ☐ Says "AI is not alive" or "computers don't have feelings" unprompted
- ☐ Notices AI in daily life ("that's the phone guessing!")
- ☐ Asks "Is that right?" when AI gives an answer
- ☐ Understands AI follows rules/patterns made by people
- ☐ Can explain what a ScratchJr project does
- ☐ Demonstrates safe habits (doesn't share personal info with devices)
- ☐ Shows confidence creating with technology as a tool

Curriculum designed June 2026. Inspired by Maryland's AI Ready Schools Act (SB 720). All tools listed are free or have free tiers. Adapt pacing to your child's interest — if he's loving something, stay longer. If he's bored, skip ahead. The goal is wonder, not worksheets.